

PURPOSE: To shorten reservation time from 72 hours to 48 hours for the kitchen and make reservations more convenient through Reach.

INTRODUCED BY: Anthony Baumann

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL OF MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

Students must email the Hall Director or an Assistant Hall Director at least 72 hours in advance to request access to the residence hall kitchen. The request should include how long the kitchen will be used and who will be there. Students are expected to clean up after themselves, including washing and drying any appliances or utensils and leaving the kitchen clean for the next group. Not following these expectations may result in loss of kitchen privileges.

The current policy states that there must be a detailed email sent at least 72 hours in advance to your kitchen reservation. This policy was created to manage the safety of the students by giving staff time to fully prepare to possibly accommodate for troubles in the kitchen. However, it is quite inconvenient for the students who like to cook spontaneously or the [Ima Baka Pi Club](#), who might find it harder to meet with a longer reservation time, and it also makes reservations more convenient for students.

Students at MSMS have different desires when it comes to their cooking times. Because of this, 48 hours may still be too long of a time to reserve the kitchens.

For example, someone with a busy schedule who wants to cook may find an opening in their schedule. However, they would not be able to reserve something in such a small time. Under the current policy, however, this would be a larger gap [than](#) my proposed policy. Under the proposed policy, this gap would decrease and may decrease more in the future.

Additionally, with my new policy, students could reserve times much more easily.

Ultimately, this proposal would increase convenience for students wanting to use the kitchens. It would balance staff responsibility, student comfort, and the ease of reserving the kitchen while maintaining admin's rules of safety and precautions

SECTION TWO (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On pages 103-105 of the Student Handbook, under “Common Areas”, the following would be changed to:

Residence Hall Kitchens: Each residence hall has one kitchen available for student use. Students must submit a Reach request to Mr. Allen or Mrs. Latoya 48 hours in advance to their scheduled appointment. The request should include how long the kitchen will be used and who will be there. Students are expected to clean up after themselves, including washing and drying any appliances or utensils and leaving the kitchen clean for the next group. Not following these expectations may result in loss of kitchen privileges.

This proposed change would expose the staff to a shorter time to prepare for students cooking and test how that would change student safety within the kitchen. It would benefit the students by decreasing the reservation time while still keeping our staff able and ready to assist if a problem were to arise.

Under this new policy, students would get to have more viable access to the kitchen and make reservations more streamlined.